

A close-up photograph of a fishing rod and reel. The rod is dark with a cork handle and a silver-colored reel. The background is a soft-focus sunset over a body of water, with trees reflected in the calm surface. The text is overlaid on the left side of the image.

Proposal: Campus Fishing Pond at CMCC

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Proposal: construct a stocked fishing pond on campus

Goal: improve student recreation, wellness, and education

Based on:

Student surveys

Campus observation

Interviews

Cost research

Academic studies



Problem / Opportunity

Limited water-based recreation
on campus

Students lack relaxing outdoor
spaces

Opportunity to improve:

- Campus life
- Engagement
- Retention and satisfaction



Research Methods

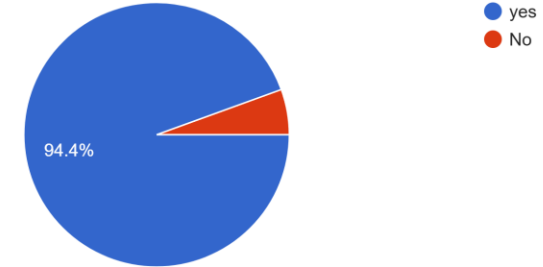
- CMCC Student survey, Bates College pond interviews, Bus rider survey
 - Site observation (3 potential locations)
 - Academic research on recreation benefits
 - Research on state requirements and permits
 - Research on estimated construction costs
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Student Survey Results

- 77% would use a campus fishing pond
- 94.4% support using it in classes
- Strong interest in outdoor recreation overall
- Positive response across all surveys

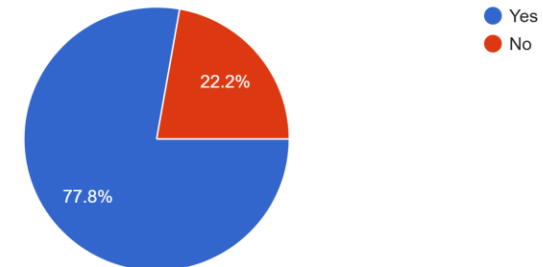
Should CMCC use the pond for classes? (Conservation Law Enforcement or any class that could use the pond to learn)

18 responses



Would you use a stocked fishing pond on campus?

18 responses



Wellness Benefits

- Reduces stress and anxiety
- Encourages relaxation and nature exposure
- Supports mental health
- Builds social connection between students
- Benefits of campus outdoor recreation programs: A review of the literature. (2017). *ResearchGate*.
- Outdoor recreation and college student wellbeing study. (2021). *ScienceDirect*.



Educational Value

Business

Conservation Law
Enforcement

Environmental
studies

Outdoor learning
opportunities

Research shows
improved academic
performance with
recreation access

Cost & Feasibility

- Estimated cost: \$30,000–\$60,000
- Additional systems:
 - Pumps (\$350–\$1500)
 - Filtration (\$500–\$2000)
- Fundraising potential:
 - Fishing events
 - Community support
 - Sponsorships



Option Comparison

- **Option 1: No Pond**
 - No cost
 - No student benefit increase
- **Option 2: Basic Pond (Recommended)**
 - Affordable
 - High student benefit
 - Easy maintenance
 - Expandable later
- **Option 3: Full Recreation Pond**
 - High cost
 - High maintenance
 - Maximum features

Option 2: Basic Pond

Recommendation

Best balance of:

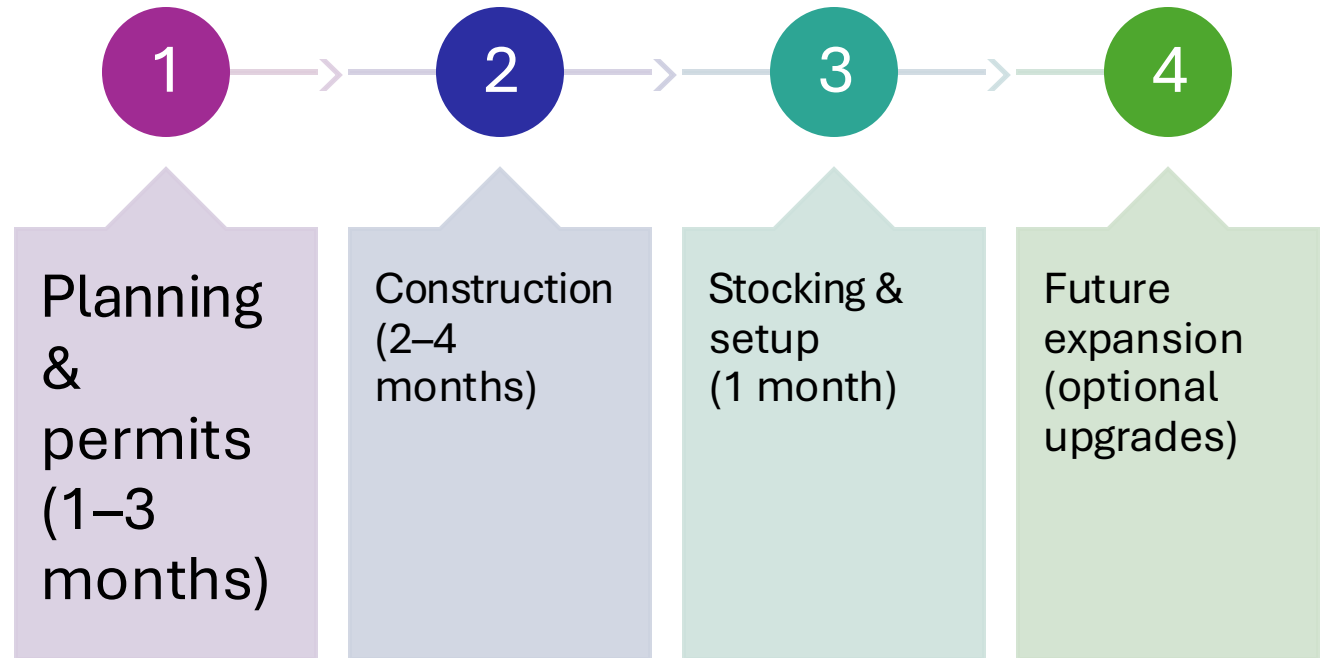
Cost

Student benefit

Maintenance

Expansion
potential

Implementation Plan



Conclusion

Strong student support confirmed

Proven wellness and educational benefits

Financially realistic with phased approach

Recommendation: proceed with planning a campus pond